

Workforce and Operational Risk Analysis

January 2025 through September 2026

Executive Summary

Northstar's workforce analysis identified two departments requiring immediate leadership attention. Network & Infrastructure recorded the highest period turnover at 77.8%. All six exits were voluntary, with half citing compensation or career growth and two citing schedule or work life balance. The 24/7 Service Desk recorded period turnover of 75.8% and also carried the company's highest overtime rate. Within the Service Desk, schedule related exits, employee complaints, lean Overnight coverage, and materially lower Overnight training completion indicate a broader capacity and retention problem.

The analysis also identified organization wide concerns. Only one documented internal promotion appears in the available job history, and several technical roles are consistently paid above the formal G4 range. Together, these findings indicate that technical career progression and compensation structure need stronger governance.

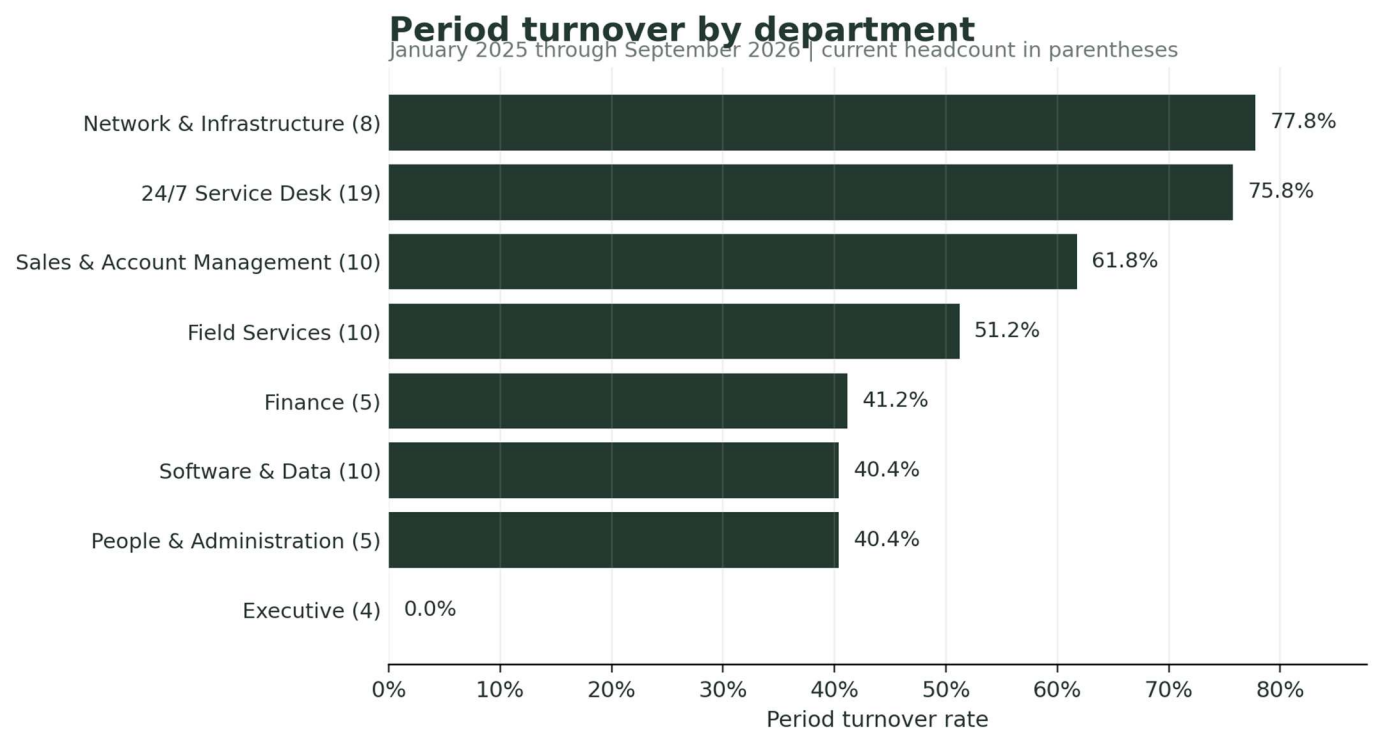
77.8%	75.8%	2.79%	62.5%
Network & Infrastructure turnover	24/7 Service Desk turnover	Service Desk overtime	Overnight training completion

Recommended Priorities

- Review Network & Infrastructure compensation, technical career progression, and schedule design.
- Complete a Service Desk staffing capacity review focused on Overnight coverage and add an additional Overnight position if the workload model shows a sustained gap.
- Restore Service Desk training compliance by scheduling protected training time and holding managers accountable for overdue completion.
- Reconcile technical pay bands with actual compensation practices and update grade structure where needed.
- Establish visible technical career paths and begin tracking internal movement and promotion as workforce measures.

1. Workforce Risk by Department

The enterprise view shows that turnover is concentrated in more than one department. Network & Infrastructure and the 24/7 Service Desk have similar period turnover rates, but the surrounding data points to different causes and therefore different responses.



Department	Period Turnover	Average Tenure at Exit	Primary Risk Pattern
Network & Infrastructure	77.82%	2.93 years	Voluntary retention loss tied primarily to compensation, career growth, and schedule.
24/7 Service Desk	75.76%	4.23 years	High turnover combined with overtime, schedule pressure, training gaps, and employee complaints.

Network & Infrastructure

Network & Infrastructure recorded six exits during the review period, all voluntary. Three exits cited Compensation/Career Growth, two cited Schedule/Work Life Balance, and one cited Relocation. The department recorded no overtime and no complaints in the exit data. Recruiting performance was also relatively strong, with accepted requisitions averaging 32.3 days to fill.

Recommended Action

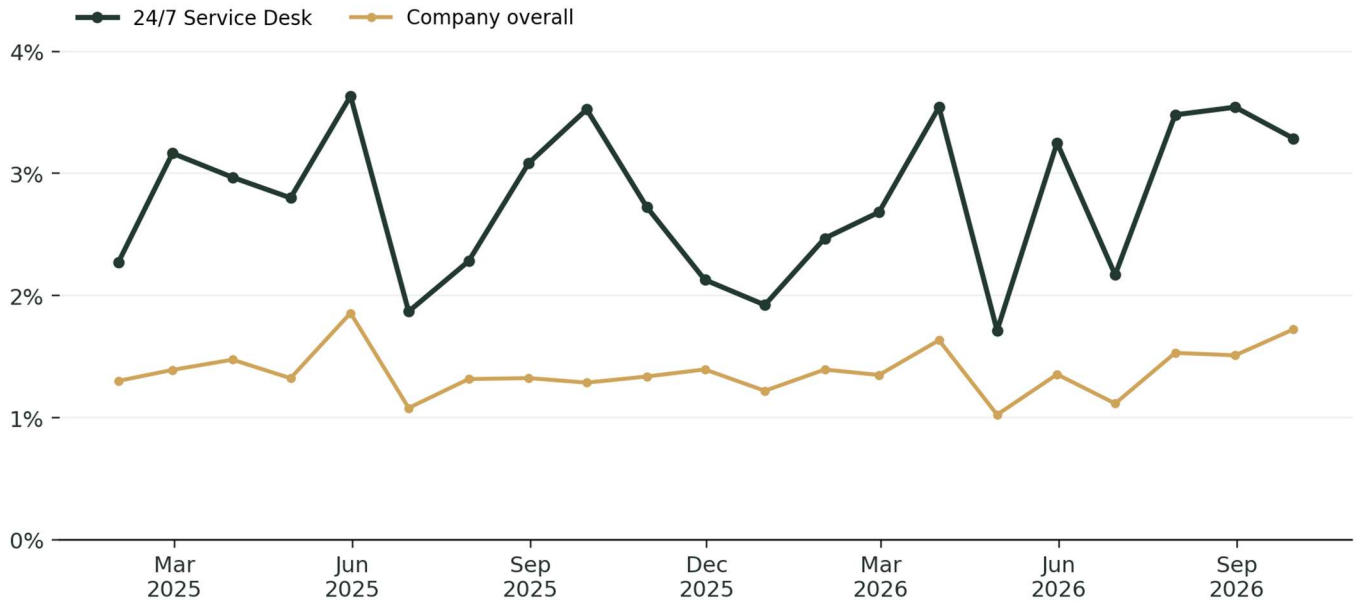
- Review technical compensation against market and internal equity.
- Create a documented technical career path with progression criteria for systems, network, security, and infrastructure roles.
- Review schedule flexibility, on call expectations, and remote work options for retention risk.
- Identify critical roles with concentrated technical knowledge and formalize cross training and succession coverage.

2. 24/7 Service Desk

The Service Desk requires a broader operating response. Overtime was the first signal, but the review shows that the department is managing simultaneous pressure from staffing capacity, schedule related turnover, training completion, and employee experience.

Overtime was a persistent Service Desk signal

Monthly overtime hours as a percentage of scheduled hours



4.17%

Overnight overtime

3.73%

Evening overtime

1.77%

Day overtime

7

Schedule related Service Desk exits

Staffing Capacity

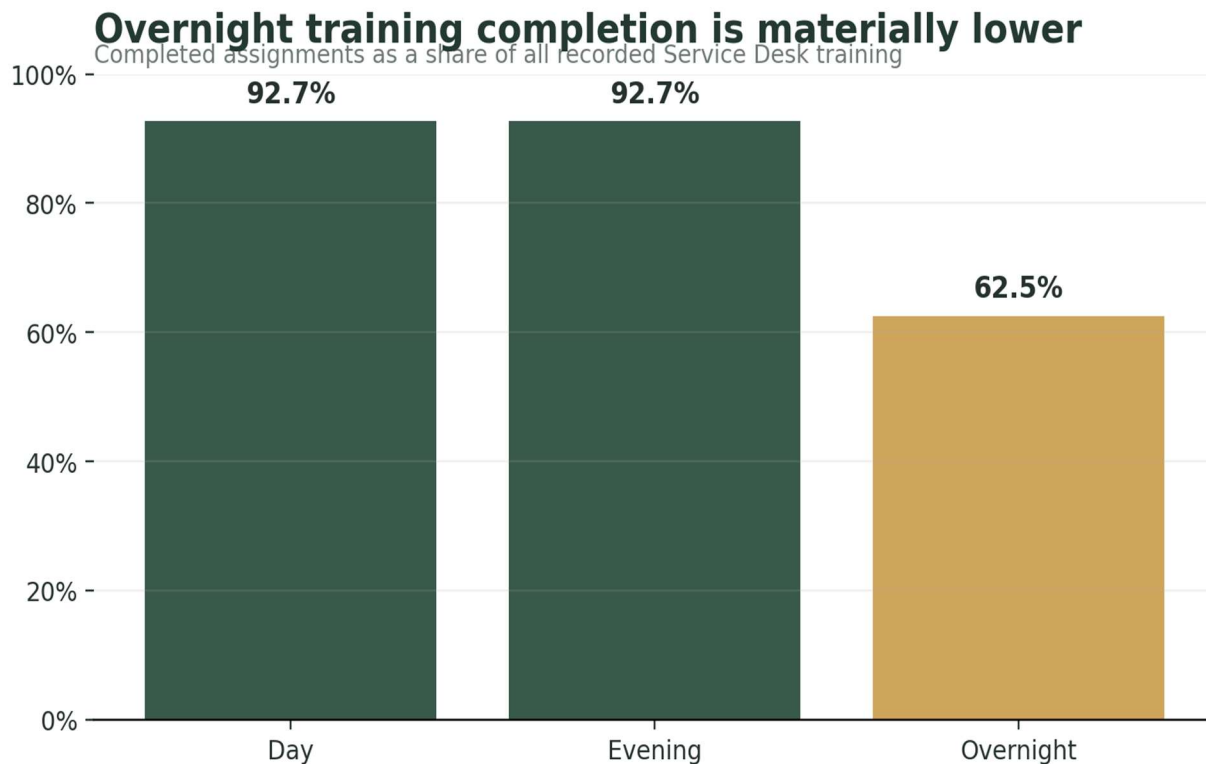
Overnight coverage is the most immediate staffing question. The Overnight shift averaged 3.81 employees during the review period. In the comparable Support Technician I analysis, Overnight averaged 1.0 employee in the role versus 1.9 on Evening, while Overnight also carried the higher overtime rate. The current structure leaves limited capacity when ticket volume rises, employees are absent, or training must be completed during paid work time.

Recommended Action

- Build a 30 day staffing model using ticket volume, priority mix, SLA workload, scheduled leave, unscheduled absence, training time, and minimum coverage by shift.
- Authorize an additional Overnight position or cross trained coverage if the model confirms recurring capacity shortfall.
- Review shift scheduling and handoff practices for predictability and workload balance.
- Add overtime and staffing capacity to the monthly Service Desk operating review.

3. Training, Retention, and Employee Experience

Training completion is materially lower on Overnight than on the other Service Desk shifts. Day and Evening completed about 93% of assigned training, while Overnight completed 62.5%. The course mix was the same across shifts, indicating that the issue is completion capacity rather than access to different training content.



Training Compliance

- Schedule protected paid training blocks for Overnight employees.
- Assign each Service Desk manager responsibility for overdue training completion.
- Review overdue assignments weekly until the backlog is cleared.
- Set an ongoing required training completion target of 95% after recovery.

Retention and Team Experience

Seven of fourteen Service Desk exits cited Schedule/Work Life Balance. Evening exit data also showed manager and team climate concerns, while Overnight exits were more concentrated around schedule. The pattern supports separate action by shift rather than a single department wide explanation.

- Review schedule predictability and shift preferences with current employees.
- Conduct focused employee listening sessions for Evening and Overnight teams.
- Address Evening manager and team climate themes through specific follow up actions and documented accountability.
- Track exit themes quarterly and compare them with overtime, absence, training completion, and staffing levels.

4. Organization Wide Workforce Risks

Internal Mobility and Career Progression

Only one documented internal promotion appears in the available job history. Network & Infrastructure recorded no documented promotion or internal move, and career growth appears repeatedly in exit feedback. Northstar needs a clearer internal progression model for technical employees.

- Define technical career ladders for support, infrastructure, security, software, and data roles.
- Publish progression criteria, required skills, and expected experience for each level.
- Require quarterly career development discussions for technical employees.
- Track internal applicants, promotions, lateral moves, and development plans in the HRIS.

Compensation Structure

The documented G4 pay band does not align with actual compensation for Support Technician II and Senior Support Technician roles. Post effective date compensation records remain above the formal \$61,000 range maximum across Day, Evening, and Overnight assignments.

- Reconcile G4 job grades and pay ranges with actual compensation practice.
- Determine whether advanced technical roles belong in a higher grade or require a documented premium structure.
- Update compensation documentation so managers and employees can understand the relationship between level, pay range, and advancement.

Recruiting

The recruiting source contains 39 accepted requisitions and does not include unsuccessful searches or the full applicant funnel. Available recruiting data shows Network & Infrastructure averaging 32.3 days to fill and the Service Desk averaging 43.1 days to fill. The current data is sufficient for completed hire timing and cost, but not for applicant conversion or failed search analysis.

5. Action Plan

The workforce issues identified in this review are actionable. The recommended plan focuses first on staffing capacity, training compliance, retention, career progression, and compensation structure.

Timing	Action	Owner	Expected Outcome
0 to 30 days	Complete Overnight Service Desk staffing capacity model and approve additional coverage if needed.	CTO / Service Desk Director / People	Sustainable coverage decision tied to actual workload and staffing requirements.
0 to 30 days	Launch Service Desk training recovery with protected training time and weekly completion review.	Service Desk Director / People	Overnight completion returns to peer shift levels and moves toward 95% ongoing compliance.
0 to 30 days	Review Network & Infrastructure compensation, schedule, and career progression.	CTO / People	Documented retention plan with clear ownership and dates.
0 to 45 days	Reconcile G4 technical pay bands with actual compensation.	CFO / People	Updated grade structure, range, or documented premium model.
30 to 60 days	Publish technical career ladders and internal mobility process.	People / Functional Leaders	Clear progression paths and measurable internal movement.
30 to 60 days	Review Evening Service Desk team climate and schedule concerns.	CTO / Service Desk Director / People	Specific corrective actions based on employee and exit feedback.
60 to 90 days	Establish monthly workforce risk review.	Executive Leadership / HR Analytics	Early visibility into turnover, overtime, training, staffing, and internal movement.

Monthly Workforce Review

- Headcount and vacancies by department and shift.
- Turnover and exit themes.
- Overtime, absence, and schedule pressure.
- Training completion and overdue assignments.
- Recruiting time to fill and accepted hire cost.
- Internal movement, promotions, and career development activity.

Methodology

This analysis used the Northstar employee roster, monthly workforce snapshots, attendance and overtime data, training history, exit interviews, recruiting requisitions, job and compensation history, and position pay bands. Data was staged, normalized, and reconciled in MariaDB before analysis. Period turnover is calculated as exits from January 2025 through September 2026 divided by average monthly headcount for the same period. Overtime is calculated as overtime hours divided by scheduled hours. Training completion is calculated as completed assignments divided by all recorded assignments.

Workforce snapshot history does not cover Reese Bell's relevant employment period, so manager attribution is unavailable for those records. The employee remains included in aggregate turnover and training results. Recruiting analysis reflects accepted requisitions only.

Conclusion

Northstar's workforce risk is not concentrated in a single department or explained by a single cause. Network & Infrastructure is losing technical employees primarily around career growth, compensation, and schedule. The 24/7 Service Desk is managing a broader operating challenge involving staffing capacity, overtime, training completion, schedule pressure, and team experience. The next step is to implement the actions above, assign clear ownership, and review progress monthly.

Northstar IT is a fictional business environment created for a professional portfolio case study.